

N02 NUTRITIONAL TRANSPARENCY | P

Intent : Help individuals make informed food choices through nutritional labeling and allergy information.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision of detailed nutritional information, calorie labeling for standard menu items and sugar content labeling for all foods and beverages sold or provided on a daily basis.

Issue :

Nutrition information panels and nutrition fact labels are often found on packaged foods and beverages. These provide consumers with useful nutrient, ingredient and food allergen information that can be used to guide food choices and daily intake. However, the same level of nutritional transparency does not exist for foods and beverages in restaurants, vending machines and a variety of food retail establishments. Nutritional transparency is especially important for the millions of individuals with food allergies and food intolerances, who must navigate many issues when dining away from home. Moreover, evidence suggests that health warnings can help increase health knowledge and the purchase and consumption of certain products.¹

Solutions : Although evidence is inconsistent as to whether calorie labeling reduces calories purchased or calories consumed, the increased transparency has led to the introduction of lower-calorie items in restaurants and other food establishments.²⁻⁴ Research also suggests that calorie labeling and similar health labeling interventions may serve as important sources of nutritional information for consumers, resulting in healthier food choices and increased calorie information awareness.⁵⁻⁷ Since there is no cure for food allergies, avoidance of food allergens is a recommended strategy for preventing serious allergic reactions, such as anaphylaxis. Food service professionals play a critical role in helping consumers navigate food choices and making all spaces safer and more inclusive of individuals with food allergies and intolerances. Food allergy training helps ensure that all food service staff are properly trained to address potential food allergens and intolerances.

PART 1 PROVIDE NUTRITIONAL INFORMATION

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

For packaged foods and beverages (including items in vending machines) and self-serve bulk foods, sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following nutrition information is clearly displayed at point-of-decision on packaging or adjacent signage:

- a. Total calories per serving or package.
- b. Macronutrient content (total protein, total fat and total carbohydrate) in weight and/or as a percent of the estimated daily requirements (daily values) per serving or package.
- c. Total sugar content per serving or package.

OR

Option 2: No packaged food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no packaged foods and beverages sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirements are met:

- a. The number of calories contained in each standard menu item, as usually prepared and offered for sale, is clearly displayed at the point-of-decision.
- b. The macronutrient content (total protein, total fat and total carbohydrate) and total sugar content of each standard menu item is available upon request.

PART 2 ADDRESS FOOD ALLERGENS

For Commercial Kitchen Spaces:

Food is prepared on-site by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the following requirements are met:

- a. All food service staff (including managers, servers and kitchen staff) are offered annual food allergy training that covers, at a minimum, the following topics:⁸
 1. Overview of food allergies.
 2. Anaphylaxis response protocols.
 3. Emergency response protocols.
 4. Communications protocols.
 5. Reducing risk for cross-contact.
 6. Use of recipes and ingredient disclosure.
 7. Knowledge test.
- b. At least one food service staff member who has completed the food allergy training within 12 months is present to handle questions and special requests from individuals about food allergens during hours of operation.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Food is prepared on-site by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and the following requirement

is met: a. Point-of-decision signage is present to encourage individuals to report their food allergies to food service staff.

PART 3 LABEL SUGAR CONTENT

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Option 1: No high sugar foods

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, the following requirement is met:

- a. Standard menu items do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per serving.

OR

Option 2: Label high sugar foods

For standard menu items sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner, one of the following requirements is met:

- a. The total sugar content for each standard menu item, as usually prepared and offered for sale, is clearly displayed at the point-of-decision (in addition to calories as required in Part 1 of this feature).
- b. Standard menu items containing more than 25 g of sugar per serving are identified by an icon at the point-of-decision, along with an explanation of the icon and the health risks of high sugar intake.

REFERENCES

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